

JAY BONHAM 5 RULES TO TRADE LIKE A SNIPER

The non-negotiable principles behind Jay's hedge fund trading system.

- 01 · Precision Over Frequency
- 02 · Define Your Risk First
- 03 · Size Correctly or Don't Trade
- 04 · Losses Are Data, Not Disasters
- 05 · Your Edge Is In Your Execution

THE SETUP

PRECISION OVER FREQUENCY

A sniper doesn't spray rounds hoping something lands. He stalks, he waits, and he fires once – when the shot is perfect. Most retail traders do the opposite. They're in trades constantly, scrolling for setups that don't exist, manufacturing reasons to click buy. That compulsive activity is the enemy of edge.

At \$20M AUM, I run maybe two to four trades a day, maximum. Not because I'm lazy – because the rest of the day's price action simply doesn't meet criteria. Your job is to define what A+ looks like for your system, write it down, and then have the discipline to let B and C setups pass untouched. Every substandard trade you skip is capital preserved for the one that counts. Fewer, better trades. That's the whole game.

"The best trade is often the one you don't take."

01

THE TRIGGER

DEFINE YOUR RISK FIRST

Before you touch the order button, answer two questions: where am I wrong, and how much does that cost me? If you can't answer both in under ten seconds, you don't have a trade – you have a guess. Professionals define the exit before they define the entry. Always.

I've watched traders hold \$4,000 losses on positions that should have been stopped at \$400 because they couldn't accept being wrong early. The stop isn't optional. It's the only thing standing between a bad trade and an account-ending one. Set it before you enter. If the price action invalidates your rules, the market is telling you something – listen. Close it. Move on. The next setup is always coming.

"Know where you're wrong before you're in."

02

THE CAPITAL

SIZE CORRECTLY OR DON'T TRADE

Position sizing is the only variable entirely within your control. Price direction isn't. Timing isn't. But how much you risk per trade – that's your decision, every single time. And most retail traders get it wrong in the same direction: too big, too emotional, too early.

The rule is simple: no single trade should risk more than 1% of your total trading capital. Not 2%, not "just this once" 5%. 1%. At that size, a ten-trade losing streak – which any system will produce eventually – costs you less than 10% of your account. You survive. You compound. The traders who blow up don't lose more trades, they just size bigger on the ones that go against them. Don't let one bad read end your career.

"Risk management is the only skill that guarantees survival."

03

THE MINDSET

LOSSES ARE DATA, NOT DISASTERS

Every professional trader loses. I lose. The difference between someone who lasts in this game and someone who blows up within two years isn't their win rate – it's what they do in the forty-five minutes after a red trade. The worst trades of most careers come immediately after the first one goes bad.

Revenge trading is a disease. The instinct to "get your money back" overrides every rule you've ever written for yourself, and the market will punish that emotional state without hesitation. After a losing trade, close the platform. Write down what happened – was it a setup failure, an execution error, or just a valid loss? Log it, review it, learn the one thing it teaches you. Then come back tomorrow with a clean slate. Data in. Emotion out.

"The trade after the loss is the one that defines you."

04

THE SYSTEM

YOUR EDGE IS IN YOUR EXECUTION

The Killshot system has a proven edge. The entries are tested, the targets are calibrated, the risk parameters are clear. The problem is never the strategy. The problem is the trader who skips their pre-market routine, enters two candles early because they're "confident," moves their stop to "give it more room," and cuts their winner at 60% of target because they're scared it'll reverse.

Discipline is your actual edge – not the chart pattern, not the indicator. Every time you bend a rule, you're taking a withdrawal from your edge. Every time you execute the plan exactly as written, you're compounding it. Show up the same way every session: pre-market done, bias set, levels marked, size calculated before the open. The market will test your process every single day. The winners are the ones who stop improvising.

"The system works. Your job is not to break it."

05

— YOU'VE READ THE RULES —

NOW IT'S TIME TO EXECUTE.

Reading rules doesn't make you a trader. Applying them — with a mentor, a proven system, and real accountability — is what changes accounts.

APPLY FOR THE KILLSHOT PROGRAM →

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